Non-c
ommercial use only Non-c
ommercial use only
Sec
tion 1
Gen
eral provisions
1.1 Int
roductory note
It sh
ould be noted that other international and national regulations exist and that those regulations may recognize all or part of the provisions of this Code. In addition, port authorities and other
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SOURCE: MSC.539(107).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.539(107).pdf
may recognize all or part of the provisions of this Code. In addition, port authorities and other
bodies and organizations should recognize the Code and may use it as a basis for their storage and handling bye-laws within loading and discharge areas.
1.2 Car
goes listed in this Code
1.2
.1 Typ
ical cargoes currently shipped in bulk, together with advice on their properties and methods of handling, are given in the schedules for individual cargoes. However, these schedules are not exhaustive and the properties attributed to the cargoes are given only for guidance. Consequently, before loading, it is essential to obtain current valid information from the shipper on the physical and chemical properties of the cargoes presented for shipment. The shipper shall provide appropriate information about the cargo to be shipped (see 4.2).
1.2.2 Whe
re a solid bulk cargo is specifically listed in appendix 1 to this Code (individual schedules
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SOURCE: MSC.539(107).pdf
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1.2.2 Whe
re a solid bulk cargo is specifically listed in appendix 1 to this Code (individual schedules
for solid bulk cargoes), it shall be transported in accordance with the provisions in its schedule in addition to the provisions in sections 1 to 10 and 11.1.1 of this Code. The master shall consider whether to consult the authorities at the ports of loading and discharge, as necessary, concerning the requirements which may be in force and applicable for the carriage.
1.3 Car
goes not listed in this Code
1.3
.1 If a so
lid cargo which is not listed in appendix 1 to this Code is proposed for carriage in bulk, the shipper shall, prior to loading, provide the competent authority of the port of loading with the characteristics and properties of the cargo in accordance with section 4 of this Code. Based on

the information received, the competent authority will assess the acceptability of the cargo for safe shipment.
1.3.1.1 Whe
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the information received, the competent authority will assess the acceptability of the cargo for safe shipment.
1.3.1.1 Whe
n it is assessed that the solid bulk cargo proposed for carriage may present hazards as those defined by group A or B of this Code as defined in 1.7 , advice is to be sought from the competent authorities of the port of unloading and of the flag State. The three competent authorities will set the preliminary suitable conditions for the carriage of this cargo.
1.3.1.2 Whe
n it is assessed that the solid bulk cargo proposed for carriage presents no specific hazards for transportation, the carriage of this cargo shall be authorized. The competent authorities of the port of unloading and of the flag State shall be advised of that authorization.
1.3.2 The c
ompetent authority of the port of loading shall provide to the master a certificate stating the characteristics of the cargo and the required conditions for carriage and handling of this shipment.
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SOURCE: MSC.539(107).pdf
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characteristics of the cargo and the required conditions for carriage and handling of this shipment.
The competent authority of the port of loading shall also submit an application to the Organization, within one year from the issue of the certificate, to incorporate this solid bulk cargo into appendix 1 of this Code. The format of this application shall be as outlined in 1.3.3.

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1.3
.3 For
mat for the properties of cargoes not listed in this Code
and conditions of the carriage
Ten
tative bulk cargo shipping name (in capital letters)
Description (describe the cargo)
Characteristics (fill the following table)
Phys
ical properties
Size Angle of repose Bulk density (kg/m3) Stow
age factor
(m3/t)
Ha
zard classification
Class Subsidiary hazard(s) MHB Group
Hazard (Clarify the hazard of carriage of the cargo)
(De

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age factor
(m3/t)
Ha
zard classification
Class Subsidiary hazard(s) MHB Group
Hazard (Clarify the hazard of carriage of the cargo)
(De
termine the following types of requirements. If no requirement is necessary, write No special
requirements)
Stowage and segregation
Hold cleanliness
Weather precautions
Loading
Precautions
Ventilation
Carriage
Discharge
Clean-up
(Spe
cify the emergency procedures for the cargo, if necessary)
Emergency procedures
Spe
cial emergency equipment to be carried
Emergency procedures

Emergency action in the event of fire

Medical first aid

6
RESOLUTION MSC.539(107) (adopted on 8 June 2023)
2023 AMENDMENTS TO THE
INTERNATIONAL MARITIME SOLID BULK CARGOES (IMSBC) CODE
Non-c
ommercial use only
1.4 App
lication and implementation of this Code
1.4
.1 The
provisions contained in this Code apply to all ships to which the SOLAS Convention, as
amended, applies and that are carrying solid bulk cargoes as defined in regulation 1-1 of part A of
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SOURCE: MSC.539(107).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.539(107).pdf
amended, applies and that are carrying solid bulk cargoes as defined in regulation 1-1 of part A of

chapter VI of the Convention.
1.4.2 Alt
hough this Code is legally treated as a mandatory instrument under the SOLAS Convention, the
following provisions of this Code remain recommendatory or informative:
Sec
tion 11 Security provisions (except 11.1.1);
Sec
tion 12 Stowage factor conversion tables;
Sec
tion 13 References to related information and recommendations;
App
endices other than appendix 1 (Individual schedules of solid bulk cargoes) and appendix 5
(Bulk Cargo Shipping Names in three languages (English, French and Spanish)); and
The t
exts in the sections for Description, Characteristics (other than Hazard classification),
Hazard and Emergency procedures of individual schedules of solid bulk cargoes
in appendix 1.
1.4.3 In ce
rtain parts of this Code, a particular action is prescribed, but the responsibility for carrying
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SOURCE: MSC.539(107).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.539(107).p
df
in appendix 1.
1.4.3 In ce
rtain parts of this Code, a particular action is prescribed, but the responsibility for carrying
out the action has not been specifically assigned to any particular person. Such responsibility may
vary according to the laws and customs of different countries and the international conventions into
which these countries have entered. For the purpose of this Code, it is not necessary to make this
assignment, but only to identify the action itself. It remains the prerogative of each Government to
assign this responsibility.
1.5 Exem
ptions and equivalent measures
1.5
.1 Whe
re this Code requires that a particular provision for the transport of solid bulk cargoes shall